Markdown Cheat Sheet

The complete guide to Markdown syntax with interactive examples you can copy and try

QUICK NAVIGATION

Headings · Emphasis · Lists · Links · Images · Code · Tables · Blockquotes · Horizontal Rules · Task Lists · Footnotes · Other

Looking for platform-specific syntax?

R Markdown • Obsidian • Discord • Jupyter • GitHub

Headings

Headings

Copy Try it

Create headings using # symbols. The number of # symbols determines the heading level (1-6).

MARKDOWN

```
# Heading 1
## Heading 2
### Heading 3
### # Heading 4
### ## Heading 5
### ### Heading 6
```

OUTPUT

Heading 1

Heading 2

Heading 3

Heading 4

Heading 5

Heading 6

TIPS

- Always put a space after the # symbols
- Use heading levels hierarchically

COMMON MISTAKES

- Skipping heading levels (e.g., going from H1 to H3)

Alternative Headings

Copy Try it

Alternative syntax for H1 and H2 using underlines.

MARKDOWN

```
Heading 1
=========

Heading 2
---------
```

OUTPUT

Heading 1

Heading 2

Emphasis

Bold

Copy Try it

Make text bold using double asterisks or underscores.

MARKDOWN

```
**bold text**
__also bold__
```

OUTPUT

bold text
also bold

Show variations (2)

TIPS

- Asterisks are more commonly used and work in more contexts

Italic

Copy Try it

Make text italic using single asterisks or underscores.

MARKDOWN

```
*italic text*
_also italic_
```

OUTPUT

italic text
also italic

Show variations (2)

Bold & Italic

Copy Try it

Combine bold and italic using triple asterisks or underscores.

MARKDOWN

```
***bold and italic***
___also bold and italic___
```

OUTPUT

bold and italic
also bold and italic

Strikethrough

Copy Try it

Strike through text using double tildes.

MARKDOWN

```
~~strikethrough text~~
```

OUTPUT

~~strikethrough text~~

Highlight

Copy Try it

Highlight text using double equals signs. Note: Not standard Markdown.

MARKDOWN

```
==highlighted text==
```

OUTPUT

==highlighted text==

TIPS

- This is an extended syntax, not supported everywhere

Lists

Unordered List

Copy Try it

Create bullet lists using dashes, asterisks, or plus signs.

MARKDOWN

```
- Item 1
- Item 2
  - Nested item
  - Another nested
- Item 3
```

OUTPUT

- Item 1
- Item 2
  - Nested item
  - Another nested
- Item 3

Show variations (3)

TIPS

- Use 2 spaces for nesting
- Be consistent with your list marker

Ordered List

Copy Try it

Create numbered lists using numbers followed by periods.

MARKDOWN

```
1. First item
2. Second item
3. Third item
   1. Nested item
   2. Another nested
```

OUTPUT

1. First item
2. Second item
3. Third item
   1. Nested item
   2. Another nested

TIPS

- Numbers don't need to be in order - Markdown will auto-number

Links

Inline Link

Copy Try it

Create a clickable link with custom text.

MARKDOWN

```
[Link text](https://example.com)
```

OUTPUT

Link text

Link with Title

Copy Try it

Add a tooltip title that appears on hover.

MARKDOWN

```
[Link text](https://example.com "Title on hover")
```

OUTPUT

Link text

Reference Link

Copy Try it

Define links separately for cleaner text.

MARKDOWN

```
[Link text][ref]

[ref]: https://example.com
```

OUTPUT

Link text

TIPS

- Great for documents with many links to the same URL

Autolink

Copy Try it

Automatically convert URLs to clickable links.

MARKDOWN

```
<https://example.com>
```

OUTPUT

https://example.com

Images

Image

Copy Try it

Embed an image with alt text.

MARKDOWN

```
![Alt text](https://example.com/image.jpg)
```

OUTPUT

Alt text

TIPS

- Always include descriptive alt text for accessibility

Image with Title

Copy Try it

Add a tooltip title to an image.

MARKDOWN

```
![Alt text](https://example.com/image.jpg "Image title")
```

OUTPUT

Alt text

Linked Image

Copy Try it

Make an image clickable by wrapping it in a link.

MARKDOWN

```
[![Alt text](https://example.com/image.jpg)](https://example.com)
```

OUTPUT

Alt text

Code

Inline Code

Copy Try it

Format code inline using backticks.

MARKDOWN

```
Use `code` inline
```

OUTPUT

Use `code` inline

Code Block

Copy Try it

Create a code block with syntax highlighting.

MARKDOWN

```
```javascript
const greeting = "Hello, World!";
console.log(greeting);
```
```

OUTPUT

```javascript
const greeting = "Hello, World!";
console.log(greeting);
```

TIPS

- Specify the language after the opening backticks for syntax highlighting

Indented Code Block

Copy Try it

Create a code block using 4 spaces indentation.

MARKDOWN

```
    const greeting = "Hello";
    console.log(greeting);
```

OUTPUT

```
const greeting = "Hello";
console.log(greeting);
```

Tables

Table

Copy Try it

Create tables using pipes and dashes.

MARKDOWN

```
| Header 1 | Header 2 | Header 3 |
|----------|----------|----------|
| Cell 1   | Cell 2   | Cell 3   |
| Cell 4   | Cell 5   | Cell 6   |
```

OUTPUT

Header 1	Header 2	Header 3
Cell 1	Cell 2	Cell 3

Header 1	Header 2	Header 3
Cell 4	Cell 5	Cell 6

TIPS

- Columns don't need to be perfectly aligned
- Use colons for alignment

Table Alignment

Copy Try it

Align table columns using colons.

MARKDOWN

```
| Left | Center | Right |
|:-----|:------:|------:|
| L    | C      | R     |
```

OUTPUT

Left	Center	Right
L	C	R

Blockquotes

Blockquote

Copy Try it

Create a blockquote using the > character.

MARKDOWN

```
> This is a blockquote.
> It can span multiple lines.
```

OUTPUT

> This is a blockquote.
> It can span multiple lines.

Nested Blockquote

Copy Try it

Nest blockquotes using multiple > characters.

MARKDOWN

```
> Outer quote
>> Nested quote
>>> Even more nested
```

OUTPUT

> Outer quote
>
> > Nested quote
> >
> > > Even more nested

Horizontal Rules

Horizontal Rule

Copy Try it

Create a horizontal line using three or more dashes, asterisks, or underscores.

MARKDOWN

```
---

***

___
```

OUTPUT

Show variations (3)

Task Lists

Task List

Copy Try it

Create interactive checklists using brackets.

MARKDOWN

```
- [x] Completed task
- [ ] Incomplete task
- [ ] Another task
```

OUTPUT

- [x] Completed task
- [ ] Incomplete task
- [ ] Another task

Footnotes

Footnote

Copy Try it

Add footnotes to your document.

MARKDOWN

```
Here's a sentence with a footnote.[^1]

[^1]: This is the footnote content.
```

OUTPUT

Here's a sentence with a footnote.[^1]

[^1]: This is the footnote content.

Other

Line Break

Copy Try it

Create a line break by ending a line with two spaces.

MARKDOWN

```
First line
Second line
```

OUTPUT

First line
Second line

TIPS

- Two spaces at the end of a line creates a

Escaping Characters

Copy Try it

Escape special characters using backslash.

MARKDOWN

```
\*Not italic\*
\# Not a heading
```

OUTPUT

Not italic
Not a heading

Emoji

Copy Try it

Insert emojis using shortcodes.

MARKDOWN

```
:smile: :heart: :thumbsup:
```

OUTPUT

:smile: :heart: :thumbsup:

TIPS

- GitHub supports a wide range of emoji shortcodes

Frequently Asked Questions

What is Markdown?

Markdown is a lightweight markup language for creating formatted text using a plain-text editor. It was created by John Gruber in 2004 and is now one of the most popular markup languages in the world.

Is Markdown the same everywhere?

While core Markdown syntax is consistent across platforms, different platforms (GitHub, Discord, Obsidian, etc.) may support additional features or have slight variations. This is often called "flavored Markdown".

What can I use Markdown for?

Markdown is used for documentation, README files, blog posts, notes, emails, and more. It's supported by GitHub, GitLab, Reddit, Discord, Slack, Notion, Obsidian, and many other platforms.

Do I need special software to write Markdown?

No, you can write Markdown in any plain text editor. However, specialized Markdown editors like VS Code, Obsidian, or Typora provide live preview and additional features.

Related Tools

Markdown Editor

Write and preview Markdown with our online editor

Table Generator

Create Markdown tables visually

Quote Generator

Generate blockquotes and callouts

Cheat Sheets

Markdown Cheat Sheet

R Markdown

Obsidian

Discord Markdown

GitHub Markdown

Converters

PDF to Markdown

Markdown to Word

HTML to Markdown

Excel to Markdown

Google Docs to Markdown

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TOC Generator

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Text Tools

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Character Counter

Text Compare

Markdown Editor

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